DOCUMENT–1

Detailed Meeting Findings Report

(Internal Circulation Version – Validation Draft)

---

0. Executive Context and Visit Mandate

0.1 Background

The Hawassa City MESOB One-Stop Service Center Team conducted an official benchmarking and experience-sharing visit to the Sidama Region MESOB Center. This visit forms part of Hawassa City's broader Smart City transformation initiative and ongoing preparatory work toward establishing a fully operational City MESOB One-Stop Service Center.

The purpose of the visit was to:

- Obtain direct operational insight from a functioning MESOB center.
- Understand implementation realities beyond formal documentation.
- Identify governance, infrastructure, integration, and institutional risks.
- Extract practical lessons to refine Hawassa's updated Master Plan.
- Strengthen inter-institutional collaboration between City, Regional Center, and Hawassa University (HU).

This report translates rough meeting notes into a structured analytical document for internal validation and refinement.

0.2 Delegation and Engagement Structure

The Hawassa delegation formally engaged with:

- Deputy Administrator of the Regional MESOB Center
- Technology Head
- IT Experts
- Main (Top) Administrator

The visit was structured into three parts:

- **Part I:** Meeting with Deputy Administrator, Technology Head, and IT Experts (Technical & operational discussion)
- **Part II:** Meeting with Main Administrator (Strategic & governance discussion)
- **Part III:** Direct field observation of facilities, systems, and operations

---

0.3 Scope of This Report

This document:

- Preserves all insights from the meetings.
- Distinguishes facts, observations, and reported claims.
- Identifies risks encountered by the Regional MESOB.
- Extracts implementation lessons.
- Highlights direct implications for Hawassa City.

This is an **internal validation draft** and is not yet a formal external report.

---

1. Institutional and Governance Findings

1.1 Governance Structure Status

Finding:
The Regional MESOB Center does not yet have a fully finalized and clearly institutionalized operational structure. Key governance areas remain underdeveloped, including:

- Complaint handling system
- Anti-corruption oversight mechanisms
- Security governance clarity
- Maintenance responsibility allocation
- Formalized organizational chart
- Role clarity between MESOB staff and bureau staff

Context:
The initiative was implemented rapidly (within approximately six months), prioritizing operational launch over institutional refinement.

Risk Implication

Without early governance design:

- Accountability gaps emerge.
- Security responsibilities become ambiguous.
- Maintenance and escalation processes remain informal.

Implication for Hawassa City

Hawassa must finalize:

- Organizational structure
- Security governance framework
- Complaint and escalation protocol
- Bureau accountability model
  before full operational launch.

1.2 Bureau Resistance Dynamics

Observed Resistance (FACT):

Highly resistant or partially resistant bureaus include:

- Land Bureau
- Construction Bureau
- Investment-related services
- Trade Bureau (Main office)

Some services were mapped and counters allocated, yet remain empty because bureaus have not deployed staff or activated service delivery.

Nature of Resistance (Reported by officials):

- Some bureaus continue serving customers manually at their own offices.
- Reluctance to redirect customers to MESOB.
- Repeated meetings (4–5) did not secure full cooperation.
- Lack of understanding of MESOB value.

Operational Consequence

- Empty booths reduce public trust.
- Service integration exists on paper but not in reality.
- Physical infrastructure underutilized.

Strategic Lesson

Service mapping alone is insufficient.
Mandatory enforcement and compliance mechanisms are required.

Implication for Hawassa City

Hawassa must:

- Conduct a mandatory needs assessment.
- Define essential services per bureau.
- Tie participation to administrative directive.
- Align with Public Service Reform structure.
- Secure mayoral-level compliance backing.

1.3 Service Identification Confusion

Key Governance Gap Identified:

Many bureaus cannot clearly distinguish:

- “Services” (customer-facing deliverables)
- “Operations” (internal processes)

When asked to list services, bureaus provided entire proclamations rather than defined service outputs.

Strategic Consequence

Without proper service definition:

- Automation fails.
- Software development becomes misaligned.
- API integration becomes chaotic.

Implication for Hawassa City

Before system integration:

1. Conduct structured Service Definition Workshop.
2. Categorize services clearly.
3. Prioritize high-impact services.
4. Create service standardization templates.

2. Infrastructure & Technology Findings

2.1 Infrastructure Implementation Model

FACT:

- Infrastructure fully implemented by Ethio Telecom.
- Software and system architecture handled by Federal AI Institute.
- Local adaptations (e.g., Sidama language support) done regionally.

This centralized model provides standardization but creates dependency.

2.2 Infrastructure Gaps Experienced

Construction & Installation Gaps

- Civil works and technology installation attempted within one month.
- Timing misalignment (e.g., Wi-Fi ceiling cable installation conflict).
- Accessories delayed by Ethio Telecom.
- Firewall installed only recently (late in process).

Technical Capacity Gap

- Ethio Telecom reportedly lacks sufficient expert technicians.
- Qualified staff overburdened and deployed nationwide.
- Installation delays linked to resource shortage.

Financial Observation

- Ethio Telecom considered expensive compared to private firms.
- Advantage: flexible payment terms.
- Lower perceived corruption risk due to public ownership.

2.3 Data Center & Infrastructure Status

FACTS:

- Mini Data Center operational.
- Generator available.
- UPS system incomplete or not fully operational.
- Disaster Recovery (DR) not yet fully implemented.
- Redundancy planning ongoing.
- VPN connectivity established (100 Mbps).
- Local servers used (cloud removed per Federal standard).

Cloud Decision:
Initially included by Ethio Telecom, later removed due to Federal AI standard requiring local servers.

Risk Identified

- Incomplete redundancy.
- DR framework not yet active.
- Security credential dependency on vendor.
- No internal cybersecurity expert yet.

2.4 Security Governance Gap

Critical Finding:

- Firewall credentials currently held by Ethio Telecom.
- Regional Center lacks internal security experts.
- Plan to hire 2 professional security specialists.
- Difficulty in sourcing skilled cybersecurity personnel.

Risk Level: HIGH

Without internal security:

- Dependency risk.
- Limited incident response capability.
- Governance vulnerability.

Implication for Hawassa

Hawassa must:

- Recruit or assign security experts before launch.

- Establish credential ownership policy.
- Define security SLA and access protocols.

2.5 System Integration Model

FACTS:

- 9 Standard Software modules installed by Federal AI Institute.
- API integration performed centrally.
- System Maturity Check conducted before integration.
- AI Institute validates compliance before API connection.

Capacity Gap Identified:

Local bureaus lack system maturity.

Regional officials recommend involvement of Hawassa University (HU) for:

- System maturity assessment
- API readiness verification
- Infrastructure and network evaluation

Oromia region cited as model (university involvement in automation).

Implication for Hawassa

HU engagement must be formalized early as:

- System audit partner
- API readiness validator
- Local software development partner

---

3. Operational & Service Delivery Findings

3.1 Integration Scope

- 17 Bureaus integrated.
- 72 services active (including sub-services).

- Many bureaus integrated only small portion of total services.

Land & Construction:

- Only 3 land and 5 construction services integrated.
- Counters allocated but not operational.

3.2 Service Prioritization Model

Priority given to:

- High-volume services.

Traffic capacity:

- Currently 600 users/day.
- Infrastructure capable of 2000+ users/day if services expand.

QMS integrated with Business Intelligence dashboard.

Real-time performance reporting available.

3.3 National ID (Fayda) Integration

On-site registration booth provided.

Strategic Benefit:
Service bundling increases citizen convenience.

3.4 Customer Experience (CLAIM – reported by officials)

- 96–98% satisfaction rate.
- Customers express fear of system failing due to past government experiences.
- Positive perception change observed.

This was reported, not independently verified.

3.5 Service Charges

Service charge system planned but not yet operational.

---

4. Financial & Vendor Observations

4.1 Vendor Assessment (Ethio Telecom)

Advantages:

- Government-owned (reduced corruption concern).
- Payment flexibility.
- Standardized infrastructure.

Challenges:

- Expensive relative to private alternatives.
- Technician shortage.
- Accessory delays.

4.2 Alternative Vendor Mention

Shanghai company considered but not selected.

Decision favored institutional trust over cost minimization.

---

5. Strategic Lessons from Main Administrator

5.1 Digitization Gap Reality

Major structural gap exists in software maturity at bureau level.

Oromia region cited as strong example of:

- University-led automation.
- Early digital transformation.

5.2 Future Vision

Long-term vision:
Services should eventually be completed online, remotely via mobile devices.

Physical MESOB is transitional stage toward full digital governance.

5.3 Public Perception Insight

Even limited service improvement significantly enhances public perception.

Physical corridor development alone does not improve satisfaction.

Service efficiency does.

---

6. Direct Field Observations

6.1 What We Saw (FACT)

- Clean and organized stations.
- Active QMS.
- Digital dashboard reporting.
- Operational customer service for active bureaus.
- Mini Data Center room.
- Generator present.
- City MESOB building renovation in progress (Hawassa side visit).

6.2 What Was Reported (CLAIM)

- 96–98% satisfaction rate.
- 2000+ capacity readiness.
- Regional Data Center under consideration for 7 cities.
- AI Institute compliance fully standardized.

6.3 Verified Risks

- Bureau resistance real.
- Partial integration common.
- DR incomplete.
- Security staffing gap.
- Governance structure incomplete.

---

7. Consolidated Risk Register

Risk Category	Description	Severity	Implication for Hawassa
Governance	No finalized structure	High	Must design before launch
Bureau Resistance	Empty counters	High	Compliance enforcement needed
Security	No internal experts	High	Immediate recruitment required
DR & Redundancy	Not fully active	Medium	Must be complete before go-live
Vendor Dependency	Credential control external	High	Ownership policy needed
Service Definition	Poor understanding by bureaus	High	Service mapping workshop mandatory

---

8. Immediate Strategic Takeaways for Hawassa City

Must Be Done Differently

- Governance first, integration second.
- Security team before operational launch.
- Enforce bureau participation via formal directive.

Must Be Done Earlier

- Service definition.
- System maturity audit.
- SLA negotiation.

Must Be Contractually Locked

- Security credential ownership.
- DR implementation deadline.
- Technician availability guarantees.

Must Be Politically Managed

- Resistant bureaus.
- Public perception protection.
- Stakeholder onboarding.

---

9. Proposed Next Internal Actions

1. Circulate this document internally for validation.
2. Request additions from delegation members.
3. Clarify ambiguous claims with Regional Center if necessary.
4. Extract action items into Quick Impact Plan (Document–4).
5. Integrate validated lessons into Master Plan (Document–2).
6. Formalize HU engagement framework.

INTERNAL VALIDATION REQUEST

Team Members are requested to:

- Confirm factual accuracy.
- Add missing observations.
- Clarify any reported claims.
- Suggest strategic reinterpretations.
- Identify overlooked risks.

This document will be finalized after validation and used as formal input to the Updated Hawassa City MESOB Master Plan.

End of Document–1 (Internal Circulation Draft)